SKINCU COLOR CHANGING LIPSTICK

PART 1 | HOOKS

Three openers. All run to 00:07 and hand over to the shared body at 00:08.

HOOK A | Original

CLIP / TIME	SCRIPT
00:00	*ACTION: Dashcam or bodycam framing. A car pulled onto the shoulder. An officer at the window.*
00:00	**VANCE:** Ma'am, keep your hands on the wheel.
00:02	**VANCE:** Driving on somebody else's licence is a federal offence.
00:05	**VANCE:** This is not you.
00:06	**WOMAN:** It is me.

The source opening. Hands on the wheel and a federal offence in five seconds, with the denial landing on the sixth. Highest tension of the three and the control.

HOOK B | That is not the same mouth

CLIP / TIME	SCRIPT
00:00	*ACTION: Close on a licence held up next to a woman's face through the car window.*
00:00	**VANCE:** Look at the mouth in this photo. Now look at your mouth. That is not the same mouth.
00:05	**WOMAN:** It is the same mouth. It is not the same lipstick.

Skips the arrest and opens straight on the dispute. Gets our own argument into the first five seconds, which no other hook in the library does. Test this one hard.

HOOK C | Get me your supervisor

CLIP / TIME	SCRIPT
00:00	*ACTION: Mid argument. The officer has her licence. She is not getting out of the car.*
00:00	**VANCE:** I cannot verify this document.
00:02	**WOMAN:** Verify what? My own mouth?
00:04	**VANCE:** Ma'am, step out of the vehicle.
00:06	**WOMAN:** Restrain me or get me your supervisor.

Drops the viewer into the middle of a standoff with no setup at all. Best for sound on placements and for a female audience, because she refuses before anybody has explained anything.

PART 2 | MAIN SCRIPT (SHARED BODY)

Runs identically under all three hooks. Total runtime with any hook, roughly 4:12.

CLIP / TIME	SCRIPT
00:08	**VANCE:** Look at the mouth in this photo.
00:10	*ACTION: Insert. The licence photo. Same woman, same lines around her mouth, but the colour is feathered up into every one of them and it is a hard, flat pink.*
00:10	**VANCE:** Now look at your mouth. That is not the same mouth.
00:14	**WOMAN:** It is the same mouth. It is not the same lipstick.
00:17	**VANCE:** You cannot do that with a lipstick.
00:19	**WOMAN:** The lines are in both photographs. Look again. Nothing on my face has changed except what is sitting in them.
00:26	**VANCE:** I have been on this shoulder for twenty minutes. I cannot verify this document.
00:31	**WOMAN:** Verify what? My own mouth?
00:33	**VANCE:** Ma'am, step out of the vehicle. Now.
00:36	**WOMAN:** Restrain me or get me your supervisor.
00:38	**VANCE:** Ma'am.
00:39	**WOMAN:** Your supervisor. Now.
00:42	*ACTION: A second unit pulls in behind. A woman in her fifties gets out. Name bar reads EMILY. She takes the licence and looks at it for a long moment.*
00:48	**EMILY:** Vance. It is her. Look at the photograph.
00:51	**VANCE:** I am looking at the photograph.
00:53	*ACTION: Emily keeps hold of the licence. She is not looking at the officer any more.*
00:53	**EMILY:** Ma'am. What did you do?
00:56	**WOMAN:** Give me my ticket or let me go.
00:59	**EMILY:** You had them done. The injections.
01:02	**WOMAN:** No.
01:03	**EMILY:** Tattooed, then. The permanent kind, they do the whole lip.
01:07	**WOMAN:** No.
01:08	**EMILY:** Then it is a lipstick. Which one? Is it the French one? The one in the black case everybody buys?
01:14	**WOMAN:** No.
01:15	**EMILY:** Ma'am, my sister spends ninety dollars on one tube and her mouth does not do that. What is it?
01:21	**WOMAN:** I have owned all of it. The counters, the expensive French ones, the one the girl at the counter swore to me by with the little gold lid.
01:30	**WOMAN:** Twelve tubes, Emily. Twelve. I counted them once and then I stopped counting, because counting was making me feel insane.
01:39	**WOMAN:** Not one of them stayed where I put it.
01:42	**WOMAN:** You want to know and I want to go home. Tell me I am free to go or write me my ticket.
01:48	**WOMAN:** And I will tell you exactly what is on my mouth.
01:51	**EMILY:** Vance. Tell her she is free to go.

CLIP / TIME	SCRIPT
01:54	**VANCE:** You are free to go, ma'am.
01:56	*ACTION: The woman reaches into the door pocket and holds out a tube. Emily uncaps it. The bullet is completely clear.*
01:56	**EMILY:** There is nothing in it. It is clear.
02:00	**WOMAN:** Give me your hand.
02:02	*ACTION: She draws it once across the back of Emily's hand. For a second there is nothing. Then the colour comes up.*
02:08	**EMILY:** Where did that come from?
02:10	**WOMAN:** Out of you.
02:12	**WOMAN:** That is the whole thing. That is the entire difference.
02:16	**WOMAN:** Those twelve tubes never knew one thing about me. One colour, decided by somebody who has never met me, and it sat on top.
02:26	**WOMAN:** And by lunchtime it was on a cup. Nine years I spent colouring in napkins.
02:32	**WOMAN:** This one has no colour in it at all. It reads the pH of your own lips and it builds the shade out of that. Then it binds to the tissue, so there is nowhere for it to travel to.
02:46	**WOMAN:** And I did not care how it worked. I want you to understand that. I did not believe one word of it until the first morning.
02:54	**WOMAN:** I put it on and it just stayed. Nothing on my cup. Nothing on the glass.
02:59	**EMILY:** How long have you been using it?
03:01	**WOMAN:** Six weeks.
03:02	**EMILY:** Six weeks?
03:03	**WOMAN:** No. The colour was right the first morning. Straight away, in the mirror, done. The six weeks were for how dry they had got. That is a different thing.
03:13	**EMILY:** But the lines.
03:15	*ACTION: Close on the woman's mouth. Daylight, no filter. The lines around it are clearly visible.*
03:15	**WOMAN:** Look at them. They are still there. They are mine and they are staying.
03:21	**WOMAN:** The colour just is not in them. That is all that changed. That is all that ever had to change.
03:28	**WOMAN:** I had an appointment to get them done. April.
03:32	**WOMAN:** I almost did it. Could not do it.
03:35	**WOMAN:** I did not want somebody else's mouth. I wanted mine.
03:39	**WOMAN:** And we have been lied to, Emily. All of us.
03:43	**WOMAN:** We get sold the tube and the perfume and the girl at the counter with the gold lid.
03:48	**WOMAN:** Nobody ever once told us it was the formula.
03:52	**EMILY:** What if it does not work on me?
03:54	**WOMAN:** Then send it back. Thirty days and they refund you. Nothing to lose, and I am telling you, a lot to gain.
04:01	**EMILY:** What is it called?

CLIP / TIME	SCRIPT
04:03	**WOMAN:** Skincu.
04:05	*ACTION: Emily is still looking at the back of her own hand.*
04:05	**WOMAN:** Now my licence.
04:08	*ON SCREEN: Skincu Color Changing Lipstick. Buy one get one free. 30 day guarantee. Over 127,000 women over 40.*

IF YOU WANT IT AT THE ORIGINAL 3:25

The source runs 3:23. This lands at 4:12, mostly because the mechanism and the honesty beat both need room that the source gave to ingredients. To get back to roughly 3:25, cut in this order.

- 01:03 to 01:07, the tattooing guess. Costs four seconds and nothing else. Cut it first.
- 03:39 to 03:51, we have been lied to. Twelve seconds. It is the most quotable passage in the film, so cut it only if you are also running the long version somewhere.
- 02:46 to 02:58, I did not believe one word of it. Twelve seconds. Costs you the scepticism beat, which matters less here than usual because Emily is doing the scepticism for the viewer.
- 00:26 to 00:32, twenty minutes on this shoulder. Six seconds, pure tension, no information.
- Do not cut 00:19, 02:00 to 02:11, 03:03 or 03:15. Those are the lines stated as present, the hand demo, the inverted timeline and the honesty beat.

PRODUCTION NOTES

- Shoot it as bodycam and dashcam, not as film. Timestamp burned in, slightly over exposed, audio a little clipped. The format is the credibility and a clean cinematic grade will kill it.
- She never gets out of the car and never raises her voice. Cast for stillness. Every other person in the scene is escalating around her.
- The licence photo insert at 00:10 has to be made properly, because the entire plot is in it. Same woman, same lines, colour feathered up into them, flat hard pink. Shoot it on the actress before she is in costume and age the print.
- At 02:02 the swipe on Emily's hand must be one unbroken shot with no cut between the clear bullet and the colour arriving. If you cut there, the demo is worthless.
- At 03:15 shoot her mouth in daylight with no diffusion. If that frame looks retouched, the strongest line in the script becomes a lie.
- Emily's arc is the sell. Direct her to stop being a police officer somewhere around 00:53 and to be a fifty something woman looking at another woman's mouth. By 04:05 she is not thinking about the stop at all.
- Keep every prop unbranded. The twelve tubes are spoken about and never shown, which is deliberate. Do not let an editor add a shot of them.
- Confirm the offer against the live lander before this ships. Thirty days in dialogue, buy one get one free on the end card, no price anywhere unless the lander shows it.
- Caption suggestion for the platform: He would not believe the licence was hers. His supervisor took one look and asked what she was wearing.